

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF SAN FRANCISCO
UNIFIED FAMILY COURT

JYOTPREET CHADHA,

Petitioner

VS.

MOHITA CHADHA,

Respondent

) Case Number: FDI-24-799250

) Hearing Date: July 21, 2026

) Hearing Time: 9:00 AM

) Department: 403

) Presiding: BOBBY P. LUNA

REQUEST FOR ORDER TRAVEL RESTRICTION, F.C. 271 SANCTIONS

TENTATIVE RULING

The parties are ordered to appear. The parties may appear in person in Dept. 403 or remotely by Zoom video. If a party chooses to appear by video, that party must abide by the Notice and Instructions for Remote Appearances in San Francisco Family Court set forth above.

A. Procedural History

- 1) The parties are Petitioner Jyotpreet Chada (Father) and Respondent Mohita Chada (Mother). They share one minor child: Emany (DOB: 12/7/21).
- 2) On 8/22/25, the parties attended a Mandatory Settlement Conference.
- 3) On 5/27/26, Mother filed a Request for Order seeking travel restrictions and Family Code section 271 sanctions. Mother requests that neither parent be allowed to travel outside the United States (U.S.) with the minor child until she reaches adolescence. Mother alleges that Father has expressed a desire to take the minor child to the United Arab Emirates (UAE), which is where his family resides. Mother states that the UAE is not a signatory to the Hague Convention; therefore, there is no mechanism for U.S. courts to compel her return. Mother also requests Family Code section 271 sanctions in the amount of \$32,034.92.
- 4) On 6/30/26, Father filed a Responsive Declaration in opposition to Mother's Request for Order. Father alleges that the parties came to an agreement on international travel during a Mandatory

1 Settlement Conference on 8/22/25, though Mother later stated that she was not in agreement
2 before the Court. Father states that he has serious, long-term ties to the Bay Area, is a U.S.
3 citizen, and has no intention of relocating with the minor child to the UAE. Father asks the Court
4 to deny Mother's request for prohibition on international travel. Father also states that Mother's
5 request for Family Code section 271 sanctions is without merit, and requests Family Code section
6 271 sanctions against Mother in the amount of \$30,000.

7 5) On 7/14/26, Mother filed a Reply Declaration reiterating her position set forth in her 5/27/26
8 Request for Order. Mother further states that she is willing to allow international travel once the
9 minor child reaches the age of 15 if custody orders are registered and recognized no later than 30
10 days prior to the minor child's departure from the U.S., with additional alternative requirements if
11 recognition of custody orders is not possible for the destination country.

12 6) On 7/16/26, Father filed a supplemental declaration.

13 **B. Findings and Order**

14 1) Given that it appears no agreement was reached at the Mandatory Settlement Conference on
15 8/22/25, **the parties are ordered to appear** to set the matter for a long-cause hearing and shall
16 be prepared to: (a) discuss their time estimate (i.e., number of days); and (b) inform the Court of
17 any witnesses they intend to present.

18 2) The Court reserves jurisdiction over the issue of sanctions as to both parties.
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